How *Toronto* Moves

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Every day, thousands of people travel across the Toronto region to get to work. How they make these trips depends on access to public transit, distance, travel time, and the infrastructure around them. Looking at Toronto's commuting patterns reveals not only how people move through the city, but also the challenges of creating a transportation system that is accessible, efficient, and sustainable as the region continues to grow.



A SHIFT AWAY FROM SUSTAINABLE TRAVEL

Between 2016 and 2021, the share of Toronto CMA commuters using sustainable transportation fell from 19.3% to 13.9%. Public transit experienced the largest decline, dropping from 24.3% to 15.6%, while active transportation decreased more slightly from 6.7% to 5.7%. Together, these changes show how commuting patterns shifted considerably between the two census years. Sustainable transportation includes public transit and active transportation, such as walking and cycling.

Source: Statistics Canada, Canadian Indicator Framework, SDG 11.2.1. Toronto Census Metropolitan Area (CMA).

SUSTAINABLE TRANSPORATION IN TORONTO

Share of Toronto CMA commuters using public transit and active transportation, 2016 vs. 2021.

PUBLIC TRANSIT



ACTIVE TRANSPORATION

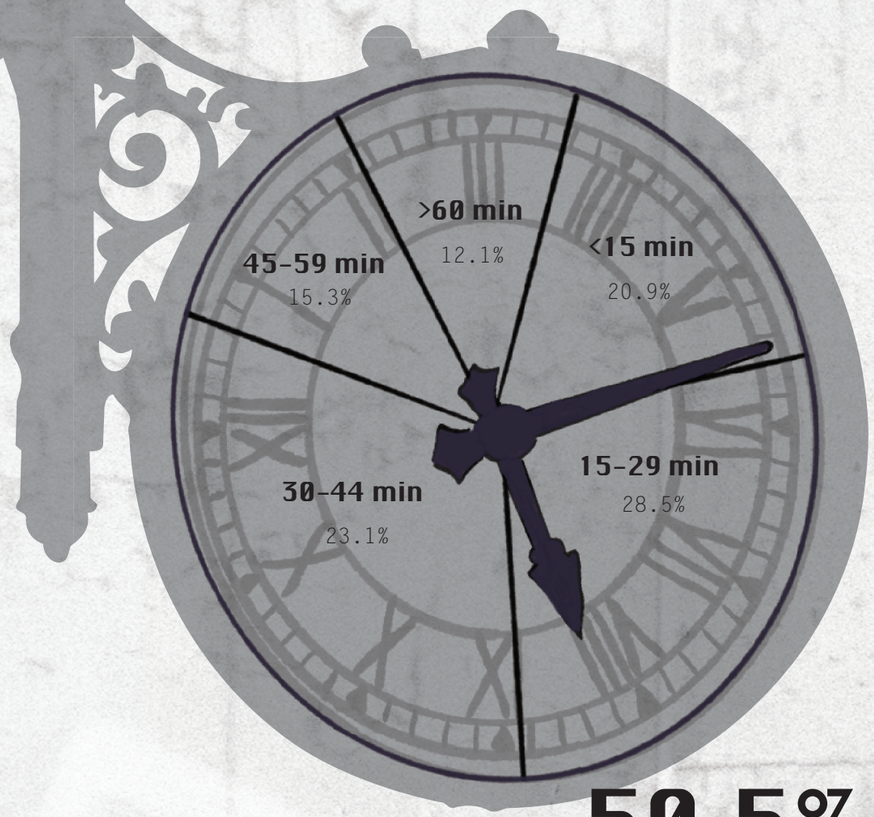


SUSTAINABLE TRANSPORATION (TOTAL)



HOW LONG IS THE TORONTO COMMUTE?

Share of Toronto CMA commuters by commute duration, 2021.



50.5%

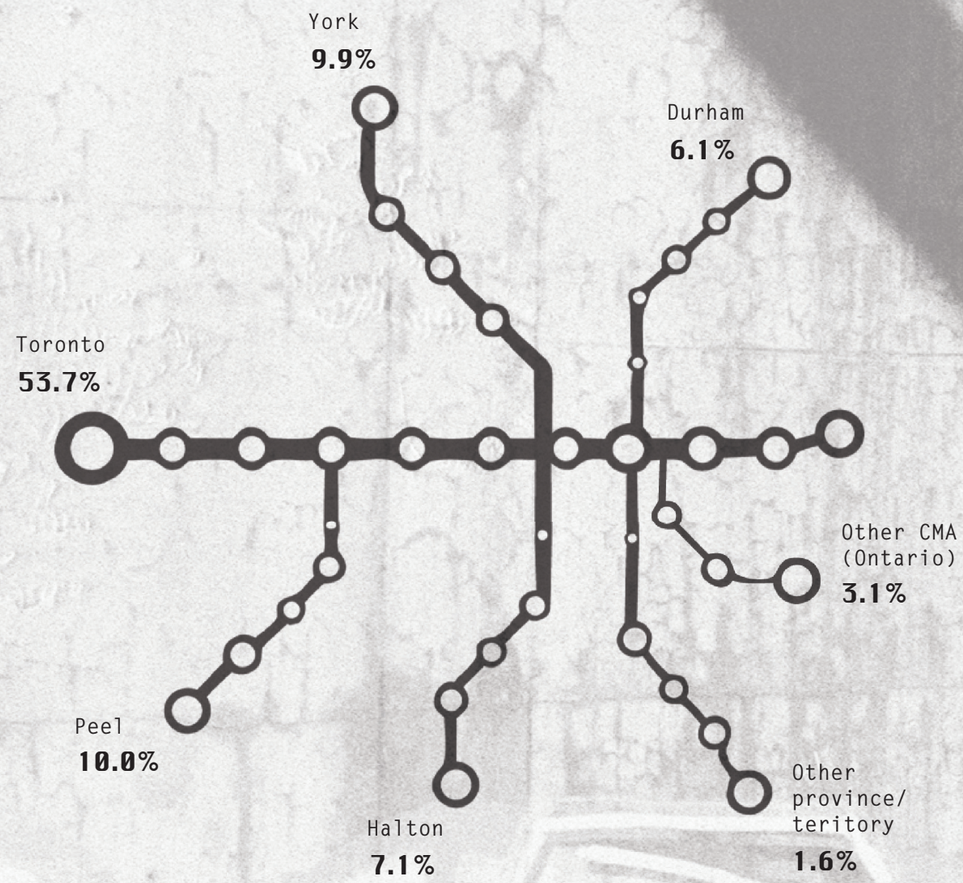
of Toronto CMA commuters travelled 30 minutes or more to work in 2021.

TIME SHAPES THE COMMUTE

The largest group of commuters, 28.5%, travelled for 15 to 29 minutes. However, more than half spent at least 30 minutes getting to work. For 12.1% of commuters, the journey lasted an hour or longer, showing how much time travelling can become part of the everyday workday.

WHERE TORONTO COMMUTERS GO

Place of work for Toronto CMA residents, 2021.



THE COMMUTE EXTENDS BEYOND TORONTO

More than half of Toronto CMA commuters worked in Toronto itself, but a significant share travelled elsewhere across the region. Peel and York were the largest destinations outside Toronto, followed by other parts of Ontario, Halton and Durham. The data shows that commuting in the Toronto region is not simply movement into the city. It is a network of trips connecting communities across the CMA and beyond.